



Williams, Sean

ZIM

vs off spin

Zimbabwe M · LHB · How to exploit — off spin plan

RUNS

520

17 dismissals · 56 inns

AVERAGE

30.6

STRIKE RATE

79.9

MEDIAN % OF RUNS

13.7%

of team, per innings

CARRIES THE INNINGS

29%

innings with ≥25% of team

SUMMARY

- A high-class, aggressive batter — no glaring weakness.
- Plan for off spin: bowl **good length pitching on the stumps**.
- Most often out **caught in the field** (35% of dismissals); most often to off spin (17).

COMMON THEMES

- left-hand bat, averaging 30.6 at a strike rate of 79.9.
- Carries a big share of the batting — 17.6% of team runs.
- Scores mainly through the V (41%).

STRENGTHS

- Main scoring shot is the sweep (35% of runs).
- The **sweep** brings them 31% of their runs vs off spin — 2.2× the typical Test batter's share. Scores unusually little off the **cut** vs off spin (3% of runs vs 7% typically).

WEAKNESSES / HOW TO GET HIM

- Somewhat more vulnerable early (2.9 vs 2.2 dismissals/100 once set). Early runs come mainly off the sweep (32%).
- Most often out **caught in the field** (35% of dismissals); most often to off spin (17).
- Vulnerable to the **good length** (averages 20 there vs 31 overall; 3.1 dismissals/100).
- Most dangerous ball: **good length and on the stumps** (3.4 dismissals/100, avg 19).

Start of Innings vs Set

Somewhat more vulnerable early (2.9 vs 2.2 dismissals/100 once set). Early runs come mainly off the sweep (32%).

Phase	Average	Strike rate	False-shot %	Dismissals / 100	Boundary %	Balls
First 30 balls	22.5	66	12%	2.92	7%	377
Once set (31+)	45.3	99	8%	2.19	12%	274

How Attacks Bowl To Them (last 3 series)

v New Zealand · 2 Tests · 98 balls · 71 runs · avg 17.8

They came round the wicket and pitched it up at their stumps. 4 dismissals — 3 caught and 1 bowled, the wicket ball most often yorker length, at the stumps, playing the pushed.

Ball	Them	Teammates	

v South Africa · 2 Tests · 245 balls · 257 runs · avg 85.7

They came round the wicket and pitched it up at their stumps. 3 dismissals — 1 stumped, 1 caught and 1 bowled, the wicket ball most often yorker length, at the stumps.

Ball	Them	Teammates	
Round the wicket	55%	43%	▲ more

v England · 1 Test · 122 balls · 113 runs · avg 56.5

They came round the wicket and stuck to a good length in the channel. 2 dismissals — 1 bowled and 1 LBW.

Ball	Them	Teammates	
Round the wicket	91%	68%	▲ more
Pitched in the channel	75%	59%	▲ more
Pitched at the stumps	3%	17%	▼ less
Full at the stumps	2%	15%	▼ less

Only the balls of each attack's pace plan that differed from what the same bowlers gave that side's other LHB top-order batters. The full dismissal detail sits in the vision playlists.

Our Best Options (simulated matchups)

From the match simulation — a tool that plays each batter-v-bowler pairing out thousands of times from their full Test profiles. Low expected average = the bowler wins the matchup. "Cohort" confidence = they have not faced enough of that type for a personal read.

Bowler	Type	Exp avg	Exp SR	Out in first 30 %	Stock wicket ball	Top dismissal	Confidence
Xavier Bartlett	Right pace	23.9	74.6	55.6	good length, at the stumps	Caught behind 25.1%	High
Adam Zampa	Leg-spin	32.3	91.6	55.8	good length, outside off	LBW 21.5%	Cohort
Josh Hazlewood	Right pace	33.5	73.7	44.5	good length, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 24.6%	High
Spencer Johnson	Left pace	35.6	86.9	46.8	good length, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 27.4%	Cohort
Nathan Ellis	Right pace	40.5	83.2	41.6	good length, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 27.3%	High

Structurally, off-spin turning the ball away from the LHB is the matchup class that persists — favour that angle when the individual reads are thin.

Where They're Vulnerable (off spin)

Per bucket: batting average, strike rate, false-shot %, dismissals per 100 balls, boundary %. Pink row = their lowest-average (softest) bucket in that dimension.

Turn movement

Turn movement	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
turns away	31.5	62	3%	1.96	6%	102

Length

Length	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
Full	37.7	80	9%	2.13	9%	141
Good length	19.8	61	10%	3.07	5%	261

Over vs round

Over vs round	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
Round the wicket	26.7	77	11%	2.89	9%	519
Over the wicket	60.0	91	6%	1.52	11%	132

Drift

Drift	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
drifts in	15.2	58	4%	3.81	6%	105

Pitching line

Pitching line	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
outside off	31.0	89	7%	2.86	7%	70
on the stumps	29.1	84	11%	2.88	11%	416
down the leg side	43.5	73	11%	1.68	7%	119

DANGER BALL — WHERE THEY'RE MOST LIKELY OUT

Good length / on the stumps

3.4 dismissals per 100 · averages 19 here · 117 balls · false shot 10%

How They Score & Get Out

Scores most of their runs through straight down the ground (41%; off 33% · leg 26% · straight 41%).

Shot types (risk) [▶ their cut](#)

Shot	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
Cut	—	72	21%	0.00	3%	39
Sweep	29.4	207	17%	7.04	39%	71
Drive	107.0	86	9%	0.80	5%	125
Work/Nudge	76.0	44	6%	0.57	0%	174

Scoring mix vs the typical Test batter (vs off spin)

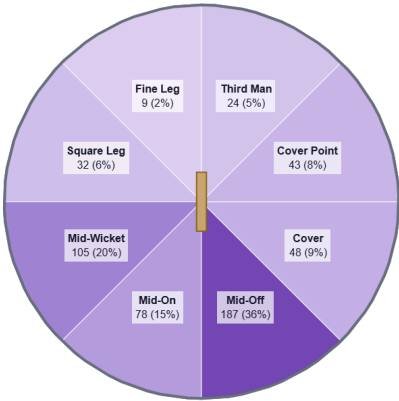
The **sweep** brings them 31% of their runs vs off spin — 2.2× the typical Test batter's share. Scores unusually little off the **cut** vs off spin (3% of runs vs 7% typically).

Shot	% of their runs	Typical	Index	Pctl
Sweep	31%	14%	2.2×	P97
Drive	25%	30%	0.8×	P29
Work/Nudge	21%	30%	0.7×	P26
Pull/Hook	10%	7%	1.4×	P75
Slog	9%	5%	1.7×	P71
Cut	3%	7%	0.4×	P9
Ramp/Scoop	2%	0%	—	P75

Share of stroke-coded runs vs off spin; index = their share ÷ cohort median (69 Test batters). Highlight = signature shot; ▼ = scores unusually little there.

Most often out **caught in the field** (35% of dismissals); most often to off spin (17). [▶ watch dismissals](#)

Dismissal mode	Count	%
Caught in the field	6	35%
Bowled	5	29%
Caught	4	24%
LBW	2	12%



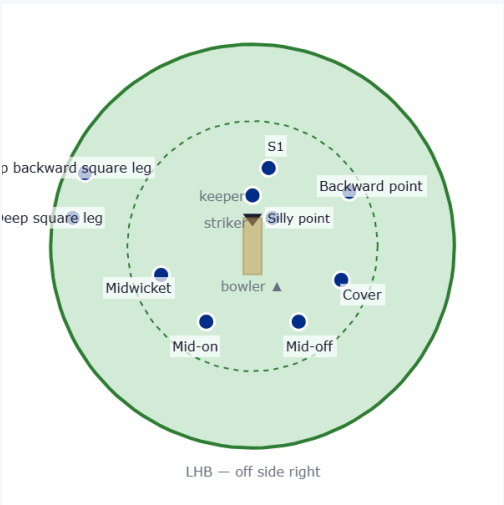
Where they score — runs by area vs off spin (mirrored for a left-hander).

Suggested Fields (the stock field ± their evidenced deviations)

Each field starts from the **stock template** for that bowler type & phase (orthodox because it works), then makes at most **three** changes — each one earned by a trigger in **their** game clearing the cohort P75 bar (do they lap, cut, pull, score square, edge early?). **Change** rows are highlighted with their stat; **Stock** rows carry the orthodox line. The read line backtests the changes against the pure stock field. Early = first 30 balls; Set = once in. Drawn from behind the bowler (bowler bottom, striker top); off side is on the right.

Field vs off spin

Early — first 30 balls · 377 balls

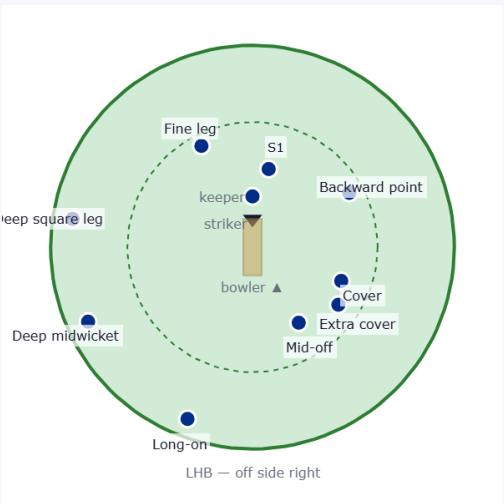


Fielder	Stock/Change	Why they're there
1st slip	Stock	Standard stock position.
Silly point	Stock	Standard stock position.
Deep backward square leg	Change	Pulls/hooks 10% of his runs (P88) — deep square leg back.
Backward point	Stock	Standard stock position.
Cover	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-off	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-on	Stock	Standard stock position.
Midwicket	Stock	Standard stock position.
Deep square leg	Stock	Standard stock position.

Stock field + 1 change (highlighted).

- Floating fielder:** They score only 6% of their runs where backward point stands — the spare run-saver to move as the game asks.
- Floating fielder:** Silly point sees few of their edges (0.3 vs 3.4 for the cordon) — float to backward point as needed.

Once set · 274 balls



Fielder	Stock/Change	Why they're there
1st slip	Stock	Standard stock position.
Backward point	Stock	Standard stock position.
Cover	Stock	Standard stock position.
Extra cover	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-off	Stock	Standard stock position.
Long-on	Stock	Standard stock position.
Deep midwicket	Stock	Standard stock position.
Deep square leg	Change	Pulls/hooks 10% of his runs (P88) — deep square leg back.
Fine leg	Stock	Standard stock position.

Stock field + 1 change (highlighted) — covering +8% of their boundary runs vs the pure stock field.

- Floating fielder:** They score only 3% of their runs where fine leg stands — the spare run-saver to move as the game asks.